



Illustration: Anil Deshmukh

Work Easier

The MS Office suite offers the option of creating templates for your frequently-used document formats to make your work easy

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Word, PowerPoint and Excel are some of the most commonly used programs in our day-to-day work. But we often struggle with formatting the files we create. There's an easy way of having a ready format for your documents, which we present here.

All three programs offer the facility to create templates that can be opened and filled up like a form, thereby taking care of your formatting worries. These programs also come

loaded with templates that can be used if they suit your needs. You could, in fact, continue to use them, unless you need a greater degree of customisation in every document you create.

MS Word

We use Word for typing out reports and creating letters, and, if you are using MS Outlook, it could even be your default e-mail editor. Here's how you can create a template for each of these.

If you send out a lot of letters on a daily basis, and if they must be in a particular format, you can create a template that caters to this. To do this, open Word and create a blank document. Type out a sample letter with the various attributes the way you want them, including fonts, font sizes, spacing and paragraph setting, and even things like your company logo (this could be placed in the header space). You can also make good use of the footer space provided and include Date, Time and page number details.

What makes all this better is the fact that all the fields in the header or footer spaces can be filled up using Auto text, or just at the click of a button.

The major advantage is that such a format maintains uniformity and lets the reader get comfortable with your format. What's even better is that you no longer have to spend time re-formatting files created by others to maintain this uniformity. (Refer to Diagram 1 to know what you can template)

MS Excel

Excel is a multi-purpose application. You can use it for many things besides just spreadsheets. The various possibilities, including filtering columns, locking views

and sorting information, make this a powerful tool for a variety of uses, from creating tables to maintaining a monthly balance sheet.

In Excel 2002, also known as Excel XP, the pre-loaded templates include a loan amortisation statement, a balance sheet, and an expense sheet, among others.

But you can create your own template if you want to. Say you want to keep track of employees' attendance and the time they spend in office daily.

It's just a simple sheet you need to create. (Refer to Diagram 2 to know more)